

Story of Revenue



The Story of Revenue Growth Machine Framework

🕒 Projects	🔗 Story of Revenue (SOR) RGMS Project , 🕒 Finalize 1st Draft of SOR Growth Framework , 🕒 Create Fastn 90-Day Job Discovery Campaign
📅 Created	@July 4, 2025 10:14 AM
🔄 Last Modified	@September 22, 2025 1:19 PM
* Tags	* SOR Documents
≡ AI Summary	The AARRR framework is a business activity output funnel that focuses on driving business outcomes rather than customer needs. It highlights the importance of understanding customer value and revenue dynamics, emphasizing that customers drive business outcomes. The framework consists of five stages: Acquisition, Activation, Revenue, Retention, and Referral, each with specific measures and focuses. Additionally, customer traction is identified as a leading indicator of revenue growth, and

	understanding customer purchase decisions is crucial for aligning go-to-market strategies with customer progress.
⚙ Status	Draft
↗ Related back to Document DB	📄 x-Drew's 90-Day Job Discovery Plan, 🔭 Now: Drew's Job Discovery 90-Day Campaign Plan (1st Cycle), 📈 Drew's Fastn 3-Year Revenue Growth Plan

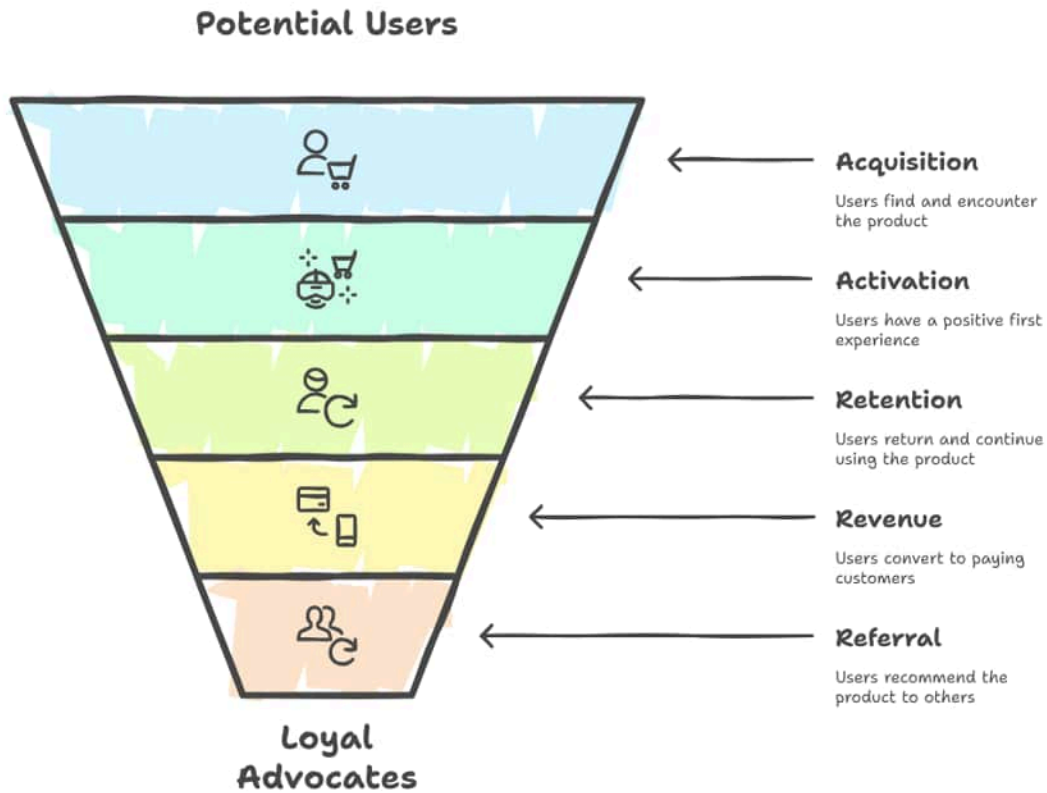
Current Revenue Growth Paradigm | 🚩 AARRR

Building a revenue growth organization is not an engineering problem; it's a system design challenge.

The AARRR funnel is not a customer life cycle funnel—it is a business activity output funnel. It describes the inputs, outputs, and outcomes a business wants from a supplier perspective. It does not describe what the customer wants from a demand perspective.

Note to self: I am not accurate in calling the AARRR framework a customer lifecycle funnel; it is a growth marketing funnel for measuring business outcomes. For me, it is integrated into the company Progress Experience Factory customer life cycle funnel. I need to explore current customer life cycle frameworks and why they fail.

Traditional AARRR Customer Lifecycle Funnel



Why the Current Approach Fails

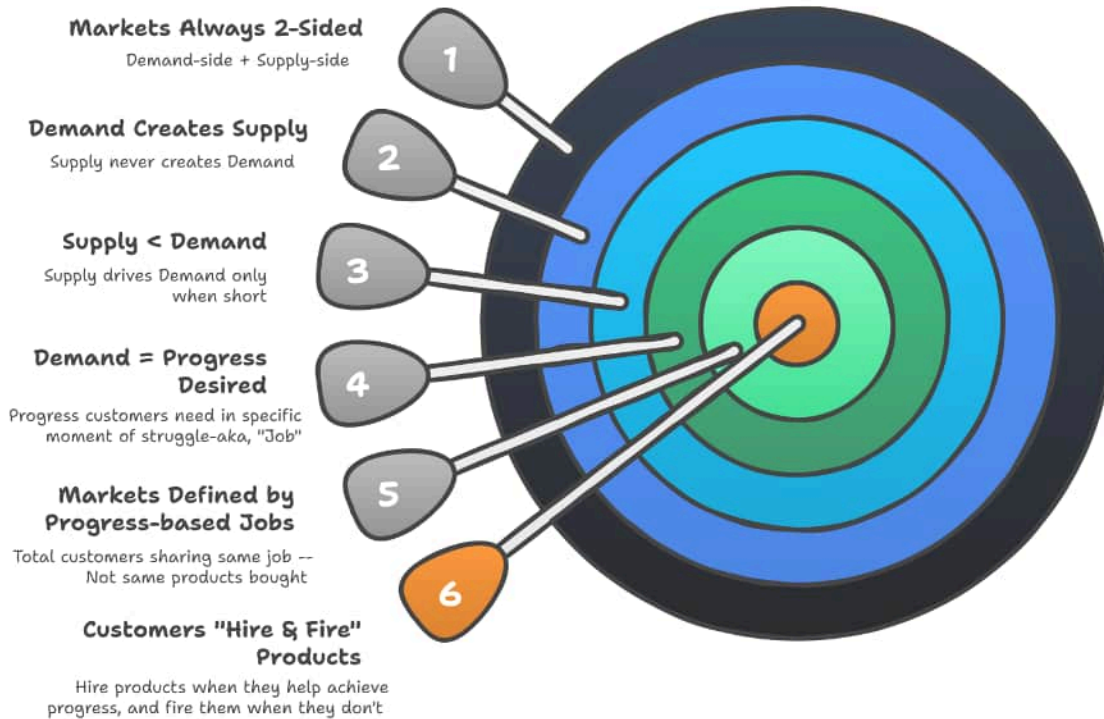
1) Fails the Six Fundamental Laws of Business



Six Fundamental Laws of Business:

1. All markets are two-sided—the Demand-side & Supply-side
2. Demand creates Supply—Supply *never* creates Demand
3. Supply can drive Demand—*only* when there is a shortage of *desired* Supply
4. Demand is defined by the progress people *desire* when struggling in a specific circumstance—the progress-centric “job”
5. Markets are defined by the jobs people have—*not* the solutions they buy
6. Customers “**hire**” solutions that best help complete their jobs (“customer value”)—and “**fire**” them when they don’t

The 6 Fundamental Laws of Business



T The 6th law is the *only* law where a business has agency—meaning it can influence the outcomes (i.e., whether a customer chooses to “hire” or “fire” their solutions). A business exercises its agency in its chosen markets to compete by creating progress-centric value for its customers that they wouldn't otherwise have without the help of its solutions.

Consider the Fundamental Laws of Business as **the "Rules of the Game."** While a business isn't required to follow these rules, ignoring them leads to painful consequences and missed opportunities. Customer Value represents the 6th Law in action. Businesses that truly understand customer value and deliver innovative solutions that create more of it gain advantages over competitors—both immediately and, more significantly, in the long run.

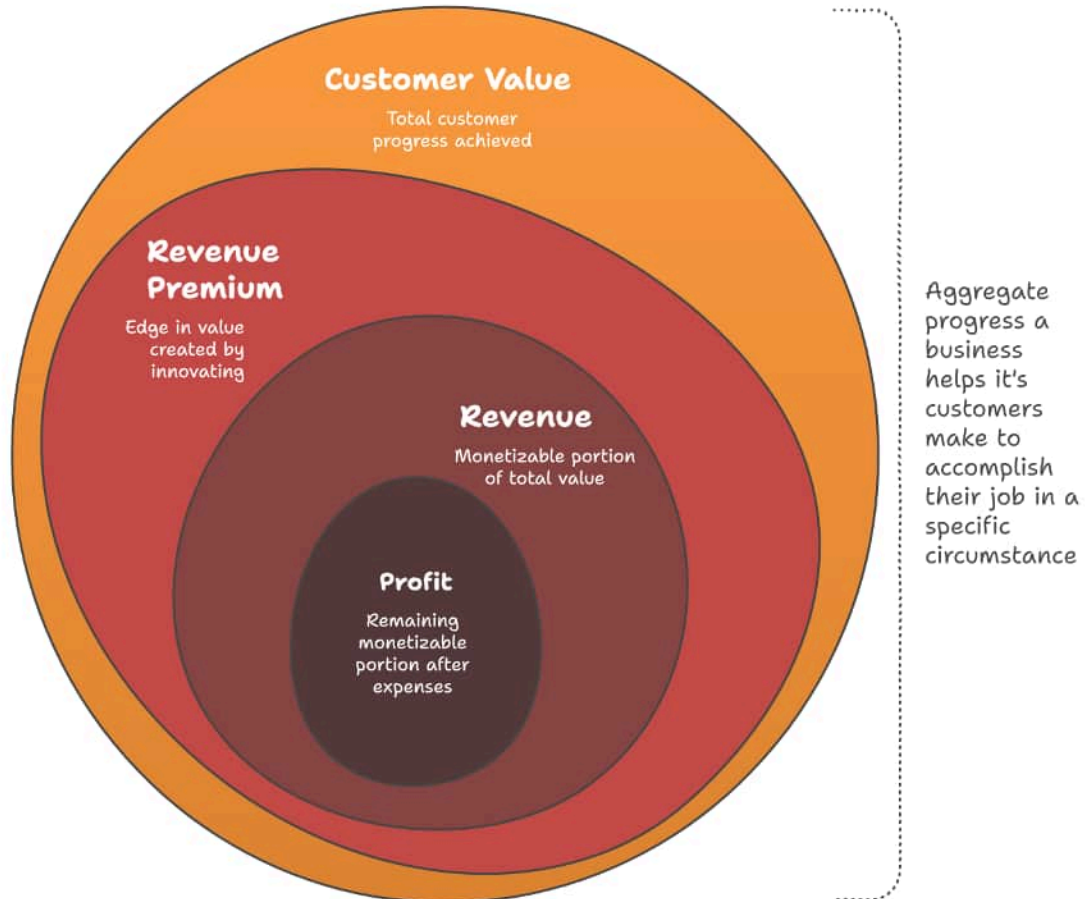
2) Fails to Understand Customer Value & Revenue Dynamics

The entire objective and focus of the AARRR customer lifecycle funnel is to *drive outcomes the business wants, not the customer*. Yet, **successful customers are what deliver successful business outcomes**. The AARRR model implicitly, *and incorrectly*, assumes the business drives the outcomes it requires. It does not. Customers drive business outcomes based on the progress-centric value the business delivers.



Customer Value is the degree to which a product or service helps customers *make progress on a job they're trying to accomplish in a specific circumstance*.

Progress-Centric Customer Value and Revenue Dynamics



If the 6th Law—Customers “hire & fire” solutions—is the only fundamental law where a business can *directly* influence outcomes, then understanding what customer value is within the context of customer “*hiring & firing decision moments*,” provides the value creation mechanics—or “*the strategy at how to win the game*.” Customer Value is essentially the framework for the 6th Law in action. A business that better understands that true customer value is progress-centric and provides more innovative solutions to help create more of it for their customers, win more than its competitors in the short term and a lot more over the long term.



Revenue is the monetizable portion of the value a business takes from the aggregate customer value it creates

Rather than viewing revenue as simply a sum of products-sold transactions ($x \text{ units} * \$y$), viewing it as the monetizable portion of the value a business takes from the aggregate customer value it creates *fundamentally shifts thinking about revenue growth from a supply product-centric perspective to a demand progress-centric one*—and accurately aligns business activities with what customers expect from their supply partners for a sustained monetizable relationship.

▼ Deadly Supply-Side Bias | The Five AARRR Stages in Detail

1) Acquisition

How users find and first encounter your product

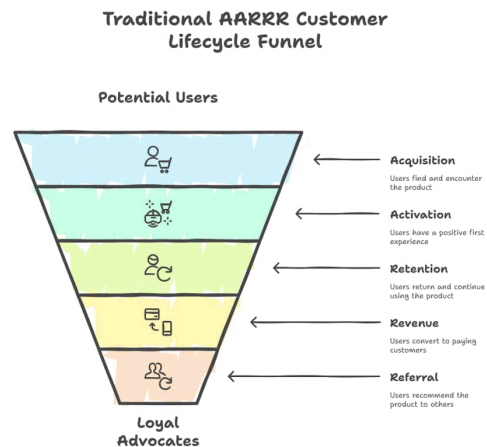
- **Measures:** Traffic sources, cost per acquisition (CPA), conversion rates from different channels
- **Focus:** Marketing effectiveness, channel optimization, brand awareness

2) Activation

When users have their first positive experience with your product

- **Measures:** Sign-up rates, onboarding completion, time-to-first-value, feature adoption
- **Focus:** User experience, product-market fit indicators, reducing friction

4) Revenue



3) Retention

Whether users return and continue using your product over time

- **Measures:** Daily/weekly/monthly active users, churn rates, cohort analysis, engagement metrics
- **Focus:** Product stickiness, user satisfaction, addressing reasons for abandonment

5) Referral

How and when you monetize activated users

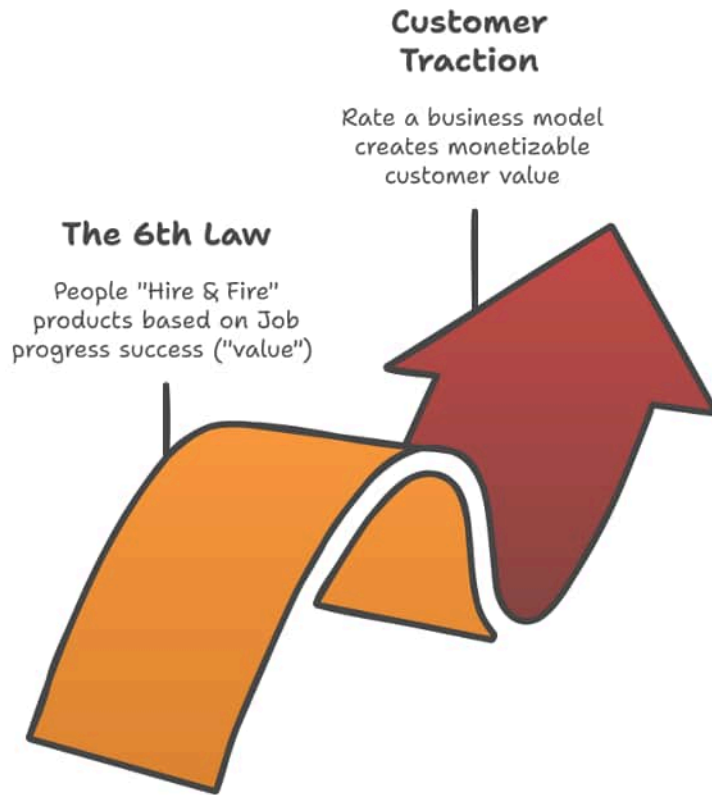
- **Measures:** Conversion to paid, average revenue per user (ARPU), lifetime value (LTV), pricing optimization
- **Focus:** Business model validation, monetization strategy, value delivery

When satisfied users recommend your product to others

- **Measures:** Viral coefficient, Net Promoter Score (NPS), referral rates, organic growth
- **Focus:** Product love, word-of-mouth amplification, reducing customer acquisition costs

3) Fails to Understand Customer Traction | Revenue Growth's Ultimate Leading Indicator

Foundational Tactical Concept: Customer Traction





Customer Traction & Revenue | Leading vs. Trailing Indicators

- **Customer Traction**

*Rate at which a business model captures monetizable value from its customers. Customer Traction is **not** the same as revenue — it measures customer behaviors that serve as leading indicators for future revenue.* Current revenue growth rates are a lagging indicator of future growth.

- **Customer Traction Metric**

The single customer behavior rate that indicates business model health and growth. It serves as the "*value capture step*" and measures the throughput of the entire customer lifecycle. Examples include:

- Active users per month who achieve core progress outcomes
- Subscription renewals per period from satisfied customers

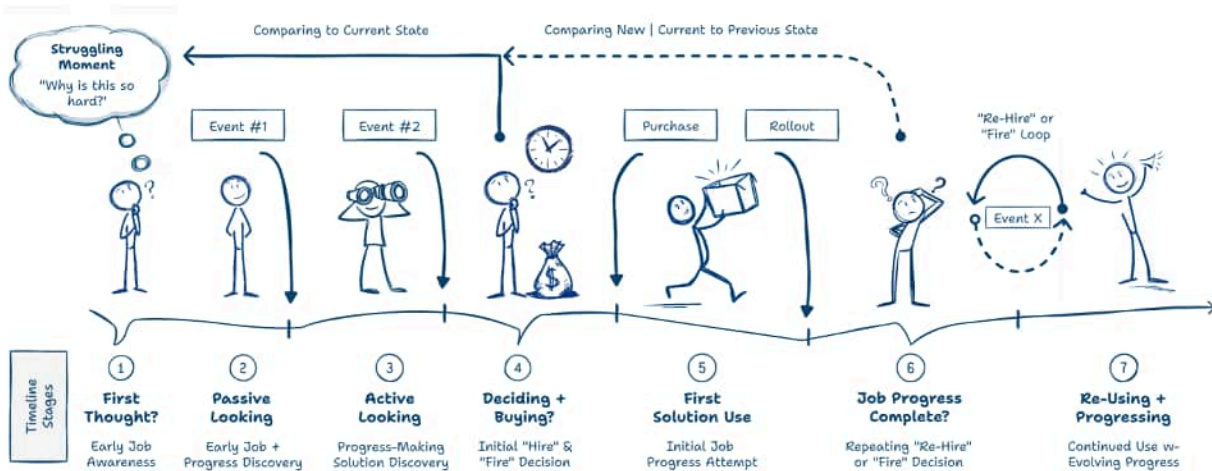
Winning by Understanding How Customers Make Purchase Decisions

Customer Job Progress Timeline | A "Progress-Making Process"



A **Customer Job** is the progress a customer is trying to make in a particular circumstance. Customers "hire" and "fire" solutions based on how well they help them achieve the progress they are trying to accomplish in their current circumstances.

Customer Job Progress Timeline | a "Progress-Making Process"



/toggle

Comment

I need to add a more context for this section:

- **Re: Active Looking**, reference Ash Maurya's definition of activation on page 59 of Running Lean. The reason why is he describes an interesting way of thinking about activation as it's the interested customer's first gratifying user experience, or the aha moment. The idea is to give customers an early value creation experience with the product, Which is a great strategy to help address or mitigate the anxiety and habit forces blocking a customer from making progress with the company's project or solution.
- ▼ **RE: First Solution Use**, reference the following content from Intercom's Des Trainers interview with Bob Moesta found at [this blog article](#):
 - **Des:** The phrase "onboarding" is used a lot in software these days – what brings you from your first use of a product to be a regular, happy, recurring, and profitable user. How does that play into this? Is it literally a bridge between a promise made at the big hire to the value delivered at the little hire?
 - **Bob:** That's right. It's helping them understand the struggles they have to go through to get to the progress they want. Jobs is really the process of making progress, and onboarding is almost like the learning curve I have to

go through in order to get to that piece of progress I want to make. For Intercom, it's how do I learn the features?

- **Des:** And when you're interviewing a user of a piece of software, is it a separate interview or separate context when you actually want to talk to them about their active usage of a product versus the day they first bought it?
- **Bob:** I've tried to do them together, and they're hard. One's like a telescope, and one's like a microscope. They're almost two different levels.

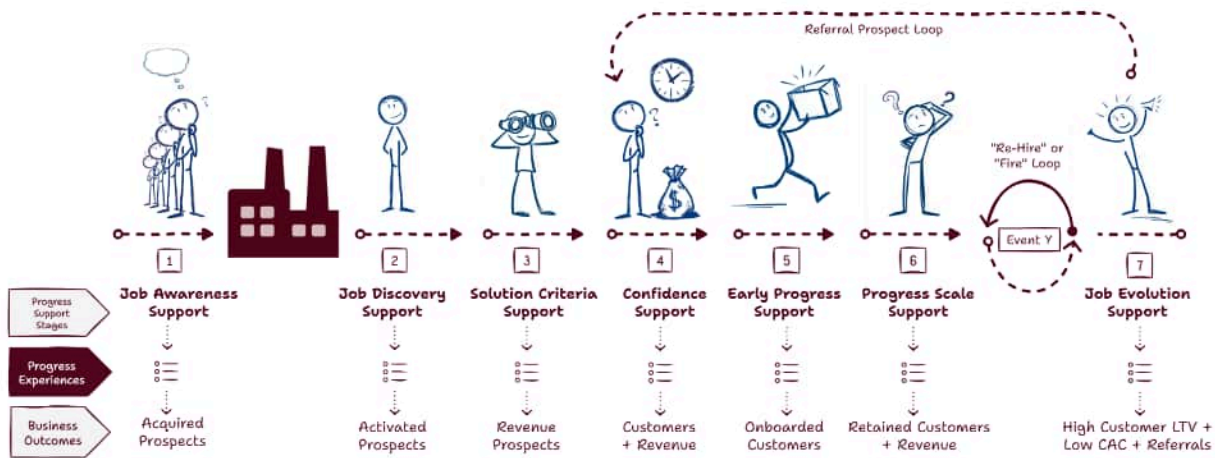
What you're really doing in the little hire is you're trying to figure out why they didn't do. The interrogation is like, "Well, if you did that, why didn't you do that?" You want to mislead them so you understand where they're headed. It could be minute-by-minute, millisecond-by-millisecond. In some cases, you might actually just use that as ethnography to watch customers and to understand the onboarding and start with that.

They're very different interviews, in that context, but the same structure holds. They're still trying to make progress. They're still trying to do something they couldn't do before. There is still hiring criteria.

Aligning GTM Strategy with Customer Job Progress Timeline with the Company Progress Experience Factory

 The "**Company Progress Experience Factory**" is a re-imagined customer lifecycle funnel that emphasizes executing the business activities that actually drive revenue growth — *facilitating the customer's optimal experiences while they are trying to realize their required progress throughout their progress timeline*. For every stage in the customer's progress timeline, there is a 1:1 mapped stage in the Progress Experience Factory.

Company Job Progress Factory | a "Customer-Making Process"



Double click image to enlarge. See below re: the **Progress Experiences** component of the Factory.

Company Progress Experience Factory Stages | Detail

Overview

Customer Progress Experience Factory Stages represent systematic business processes designed to facilitate specific customer job progress experiences from initial purchase through repeat usage and repeat purchases. Unlike traditional business-outcome-focused stages, these stages organize business activities around helping customers make progress through their natural job progress timeline while achieving essential business outcomes as a result of effective customer job progress facilitation.

▼ Stage 1: Job Awareness Support

▼ Prospect Progress Experience

What the prospect needs:

- Recognition and articulation of their struggle patterns to create awareness of their Job.

Customer Job Progress Timeline Stage Mapping:

- Stage 1: First Thought? — Initial recognition of struggling moment in a specific circumstance

Progress Experience Objectives:

- Help potential prospects recognize common struggle patterns in their circumstance
- Provide frameworks for understanding Job categories and Job progress possibilities
- Enable prospects to articulate their Job progress objectives more clearly
- Support transition from vague frustration to specific Job awareness

▼ Critical Business Activities

- Struggle pattern education content creation and distribution
- Job awareness building through problem articulation frameworks
- Market research focused on common struggle triggers and Job patterns
- Thought leadership positioning around prospect Job progress challenges

▼ Business Outcomes Achieved



Primary outcome & Customer Traction Roadmap input:

- **Acquired Prospect** - Initial identification and connection with prospects early in discovery

Secondary outcomes:

- Higher quality lead identification through Job-based targeting
- More qualified prospects who understand their own Job progress needs
- Reduced time waste on prospects without relevant Jobs
- Enhanced market positioning around Job understanding expertise

▼ **Stage 2: Job Discovery Support**

▼ **Prospect Progress Experience**

What the prospect needs:

- Low-pressure exploration of possible approaches and solution categories

Customer Job Progress Timeline Stage Mapping:

- Stage 2: Passive Looking — Low-intensity education and discovery.

Progress Experience Objectives:

- Provide educational resources about decision requirements and solution approaches
- Help prospects understand different Job progress-making options available to them
- Support prospect-driven discovery at their own pace and timeline
- Enable informed exploration that builds solution category awareness

▼ **Critical Business Activities**

- Educational content creation around solution approaches and Job completion methods

- Low-commitment discovery tools and assessment frameworks
- Job-focused thought leadership and industry insights
- Community building around common Job patterns and Job progress challenges

▼ Business Outcomes Achieved



Primary outcome & Customer Traction Roadmap input:

- **Activated Prospect**- Qualified prospect where the beginning of a meaningful business relationship is established

Secondary outcomes:

- Building trust through helpful, non-pressured education
- Establishing expertise and credibility with prospect in customer Job understanding
- Creating preference through valuable discovery support
- Generating inbound interest through helpful content and frameworks

▼ Stage 3: Solution Criteria Support

▼ Prospect Progress Experience

What the prospect needs:

- Structured comparison and solution evaluation with Job progress feasibility assessment

Customer Job Progress Timeline Stage Mapping:

- Stage 3: Active Looking — Job progress-making solution discovery.

progress Experience Objectives:

- Provide frameworks for systematic solution evaluation
- Help prospects assess Job progress feasibility with different approaches

- Support informed comparison between alternatives
- Enable confidence building in solution selection process

▼ **Critical Business Activities**

- Evaluation framework development and sharing
- Comparison guides and decision-making support tools
- Job progress feasibility assessment and planning
- Consultative conversations focused on understanding the prospect's Job success rather than product features

▼ **Business Outcomes Achieved**



Primary outcome & Customer Traction Roadmap input:

- **Revenue Prospect** - Prospects moving to their "Deciding + Buying?" Job progress stage

Secondary outcomes:

- Higher conversion rates through better-informed prospects
- Shorter sales cycles through systematic evaluation support
- Competitive differentiation through superior evaluation facilitation
- Stronger prospect relationships built on understanding their Job and their Job progress requirements rather than overt pressure

▼ **Stage 4: Confidence Support**

▼ **Prospect Progress Experience**

What the prospect needs:

- Final confidence building and commitment support for solution hiring decisions

Customer Job Progress Timeline Stage Mapping:

- Stage 4: Deciding + Buying? — Initial "Hire" decision for new solution & concurrent "Fire" decision for old solution.

progress Experience Objectives:

- Address final concerns about Job progress feasibility and solution fit
- Support implementation planning and success probability validation
- Help prospects visualize successful Job completion with chosen solution
- Enable confident hiring decisions based on Job progress potential

▼ Critical Business Activities

- Implementation planning and success visualization
- Risk assessment and mitigation planning
- Success probability validation and confidence building
- Job progress guarantee development and commitment facilitation

▼ Business Outcomes Achieved



Primary outcome & Customer Traction Roadmap input:

- **Customer + Revenue** - Can be net new, retained, or referred customers and related revenue.

Secondary outcomes:

- Higher close rates through addressing actual prospect concerns
- Faster implementation starts due to pre-planning during sales process
- Reduced buyer's remorse through thorough confidence building
- Premium pricing justification through demonstrated Job understanding

▼ **Stage 5: Early Progress Support**

▼ **Customer Progress Experience**

What the customer needs:

- Successful first Job completion attempts with hands-on support

Customer Job Progress Timeline Stage Mapping:

- Stage 5: First Use — Initial Job completion attempt using hired solution.

progress Experience Objectives:

- Provide hands-on support for achieving early Job completion success
- Help customers navigate initial implementation challenges
- Enable quick wins that demonstrate Job progress potential
- Support learning and adaptation during first Job completion attempts

▼ **Critical Business Activities**

- Job-focused implementation support rather than product feature training

- Early success planning and achievement facilitation
- Job progress tracking and optimization during initial use
- Rapid response support for Job completion challenges

▼ **Business Outcomes Achieved**



Primary outcome & Customer Traction Roadmap input:

- **Onboarded Customer** - Ensuring continued value realization and satisfaction

Secondary outcomes:

- Reduced time-to-value through focus on Job completion rather than feature training
- Higher customer satisfaction through actual Job progress achievement
- Lower churn risk through early success experiences
- Stronger customer relationships through demonstrated commitment to customer Job progress

▼ **Stage 6: Progress Scale Support**

▼ **Customer Progress Experience**

What the customer needs:

- Mastering consistent Job completion and optimizing Job progress-making efficiency

Customer Job Progress Timeline Stage Mapping:

- Stage 6: Job Complete? — Evaluating Job evolution and related Job progress requirements, and the repeating "Re-Hire" or "Fire" decision loop for the already hired solution.

progress Experience Objectives:

- Help customers optimize their Job completion approach and efficiency
- Support mastery development in Job progress-making with the solution

- Enable consistent success and reduced Job completion friction
- Provide advanced techniques and best practices for sustained Job progress

▼ Critical Business Activities

- Job progress optimization consulting and advanced training
- Best practices sharing and mastery development support
- Efficiency improvement planning and implementation
- Advanced feature introduction aligned with Job completion enhancement

▼ Business Outcomes Achieved



Primary outcome & Customer Traction Roadmap input:

- **Retained Customer + Referrals** - Solution's Job progress support is repeatedly proven, leading to customer retainment and referrals

Secondary outcomes:

- Increased customer lifetime value through mastery development
- Reduced support costs through customer competency building
- Enhanced customer satisfaction through improved Job completion efficiency
- Competitive advantage through superior Job progress optimization support

▼ Stage 7: Job Evolution Support

▼ Customer Progress Experience

What the customer needs:

- Ongoing Job completion success and Job evolution support as circumstances change

Customer Job Progress Timeline Stage Mapping:

- Stage 7: Re-Using + Progressing — Continued Use w-Sustainable Progress

progress Experience Objectives:

- Maintain continuous understanding of evolving Job requirements
- Adapt offering and support to changing customer Job progress needs
- Enable sustained success as customer circumstance and Job requirements evolve
- Support expansion into related Job areas and new Job progress opportunities

▼ Critical Business Activities

- Continuous Job understanding maintenance and evolution tracking
- Adaptive offering development based on changing customer needs
- Expansion opportunity identification through related Job discovery
- Customer success story development and advocacy activation support

▼ Business Outcomes Achieved



Primary outcome & Customer Traction Roadmap input:

- **Higher Customer LTV + Lower CAC** - Maximum Customer Lifetime Value (LTV) achievement through maintaining Job intimacy (i.e., deep understanding) of customer's Job evolution (i.e., emerging struggles and new progress requirements), directly resulting in lower Customer Acquisition Costs (CAC).

Secondary outcomes:

- Maximum customer lifetime value through sustained partnership
- Natural expansion opportunities through Job Evolution support
- Organic referrals through customer Job progress success stories
- Sustainable competitive advantage through Job intimacy and evolution tracking

▼ Critical Benefits of the Progress Experience Factory Customer Lifecycle

▼ Why Progress Experience Factory Stages Drive Better Business Outcomes

- **Higher Conversion Rates:** By focusing on facilitating customer Job progress rather than pushing business outcomes, customers naturally move toward purchasing decisions with greater confidence and commitment.
- **Shorter Sales Cycles:** Customers who receive appropriate Job Experience support move through their timeline more efficiently, reducing time from initial contact to revenue generation.
- **Reduced Customer Acquisition Costs:** Word-of-mouth referrals increase when customers experience genuine Job progress support, reducing marketing and sales costs over time.

- **Increased Customer Lifetime Value:** Customers who achieve sustained Job progress stay longer and expand their usage, increasing overall relationship value.
- **Sustainable Competitive Advantage:** Competitors can copy features and pricing but cannot quickly replicate deep organizational competency in customer Job understanding and Job progress facilitation.

▼ Integration with Traditional Business Metrics

Progress Experience Factory Stages don't eliminate traditional business metrics but provide leading indicators that drive lagging outcome measures:

- **Job Awareness Support effectiveness** → drives Lead Discovery quality and volume
- **Job Discovery Support quality** → drives Acquisition conversion rates and speed
- **Solution Criteria Support success** → drives higher close rates and shorter sales cycles
- **Confidence Support building effectiveness** → drives Revenue achievement
- **Early Progress Support quality** → drives onboarding success and reduced churn
- **Progress Scale Support success** → drives Retention and expansion opportunities
- **Job Evolution Support effectiveness** → drives maximum Retention and Referral generation

This framework allows businesses to maintain focus on essential business outcomes while organizing activities around what actually drives those outcomes: **effective customer job progress facilitation.**

Delivering Job Progress Experiences | How You Actually Win Customers and Grow Revenue



Progress Experiences are the customer's *lived experiences* while trying to make progress on their job during their progress timeline — encompassing all their struggles and interactions with the solutions and companies they encounter from purchasing to continued use. Companies can design and deliver progress experiences that help the customer during each stage of their progress timeline.

The Progress Experience Factory is powered by its Progress Experiences component — think about it as the Factory's engine. The amount of power the Progress Experiences engine can produce determines the **quality, quantity, and rate** at which the Factory produces happy customers that then drive high revenue growth and customer LTV, low CAC, and organic referrals.

It is the business' responsibility to understand their customers' jobs and the progress they are trying to make throughout their progress timeline to design and deliver the progress experiences that help their customer achieve desired progress through each stage of their progress timeline.

Delivering unique and optimal progress experiences creates enduring and difficult-to-replicate competitive advantages:

1. Companies that discovery, design, and deliver optimal progress experiences to the customer throughout their job progress timeline, **WIN** 🏆🏆.
2. To the extent a business supports and delivers better customer progress experiences compared to competitive alternatives can **charge revenue premiums** 💰💰 for their solutions.
3. Successfully and repeatedly delivering optimal progress experiences from one customer engagement to the next is how companies successfully achieve their internal business outcomes and revenue growth goals
4. Continuously innovating and optimizing on progress experiences delivered to customers drives high conversion rates across the customer lifecycle relative to competitors.

Finally, Factory stage-specific progress experience metrics track the activities the business does to help the customer achieve their required progress, and they replace the vanity metrics in traditional customer funnels (i.e., traffic sources, cost per acquisition (CPA), conversion rates, active users, churn rates, cohort analysis, engagement metrics. etc.).

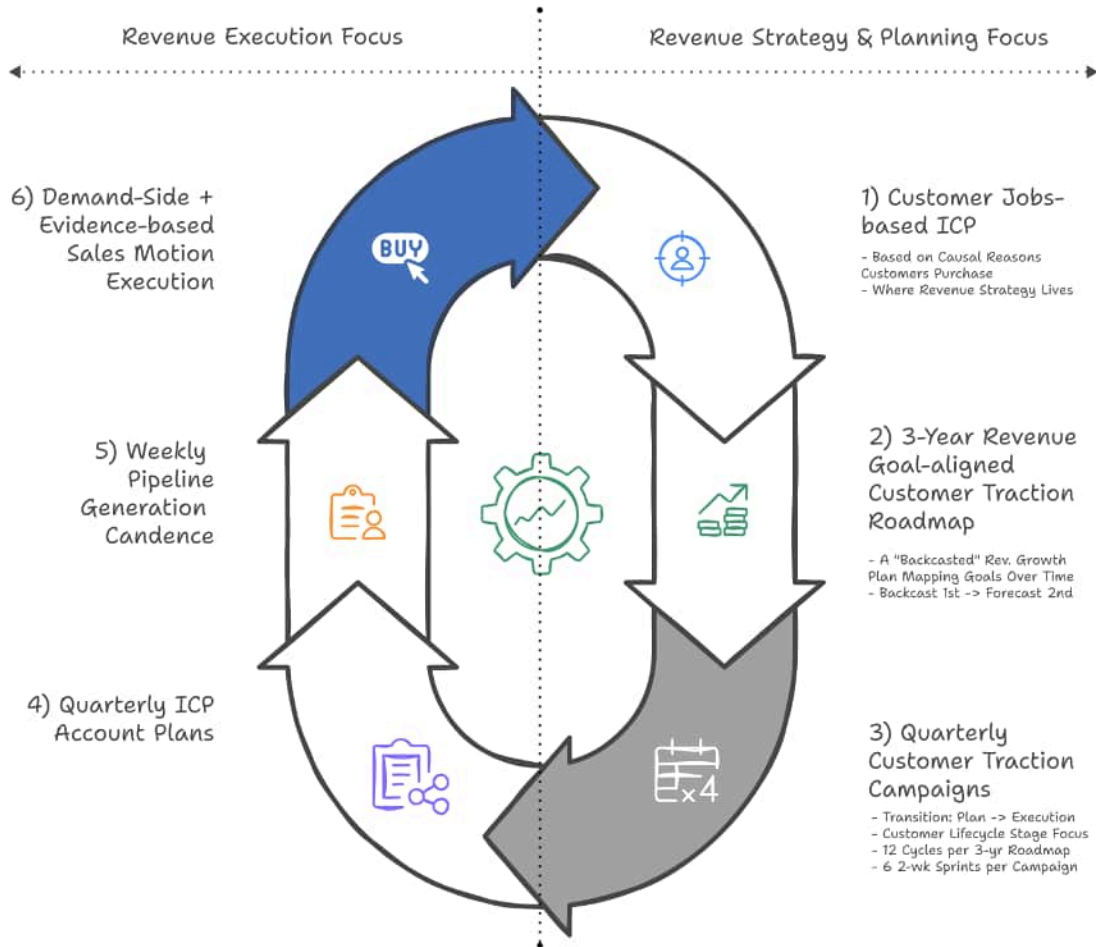
Story of Revenue Growth Machine Framework

Story of Revenue Growth Machine



The **Story of Revenue Growth Machine** is a 6-stage operational framework for building and maintaining a repeatable + scalable + sustainable revenue growth engine for businesses selling industry-focused solutions with a recurring pricing model.

Story of Revenue Growth Machine: Process View



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